

ARJUN THAKUR

Creative Operations Manager / Visualizer

19+ Years of Creative Excellence

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

End-to-End Creative Operations Leader with over 19 years of experience in communication design, including a 15-year tenure of progressive growth across various formats at Reliance Retail. Adept at managing the complete creative lifecycle, from initial design conceptualization to overseeing multi-lingual artwork localization, quality assurance, and vendor-managed print production, alongside integrating Generative AI-assisted design workflows. Proven track record of directing 10+ member design studios, executing large-scale store branding, and orchestrating high-volume print and digital campaigns. Highly skilled in vendor management, ensuring strict brand compliance, and delivering measurable improvements in project turnaround times.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Pre-Press & Print File Release
(Press ads, Mailers, Billboards)
- Generative AI-Assisted Design Workflows
- Creative & Studio Operations Management
- Retail Marketing Campaign Execution
- Print & Digital High-Volume Production
- Social Media Content Design
(WhatsApp, FB, Video, Giff)
- Multi-City / Multi-Lingual Campaign Rollouts
- Cross-Functional & Studio Team Leadership
- Vendor Coordination & Print Production Quality Control
- In-Store Branding & New Store Launch Campaigns

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager – Creative Operations & Marketing (Visualizer)

May 2025 – Present (1 Year 2 Months)

CENTRO Grocery | Reliance Retail

- Directed the complete visual identity and end-to-end in-store branding as the sole creative designer and lead for a small-budget retail format, successfully executing rollouts across 10 locations.
- Managed high-volume promotional deliverables for 15 stores, encompassing weekly localized offer leaflets, in-store POS materials, seasonal campaign assets, WhatsApp banners, and SMS creatives.
- Coordinated with internal stakeholders to drive project lifecycles, ensuring strict brand compliance and unified creative consistency across all physical and digital touchpoints.

Manager – Creative Operations & Marketing

May 2023 – May 2025 (2 Years)

METRO Wholesale | Reliance Retail

- Creative execution as per activation calendar for the year, basis brand/category focus.
- Delivered high-volume, geographically tailored, and multi-lingual creative assets across ATL, BTL, and new store opening channels nationwide.
- Directed multi-vendor print production operations, enforcing rigorous quality control standards and ensuring on-time delivery for all brand and category-focused campaigns across all locations.

Deputy Manager – Creative Operations & Marketing

May 2020 – May 2023 (3 Years)

Reliance JioMart B2B | Reliance Retail

- Designed promotional materials: Press Ads, Standees, Hoardings, Leaflets, Pallet Wraps & Dropdowns.
- Engineered scripted, template-based automation workflows that successfully scaled the production of localized offer leaflets across 200+ locations, specifically targeting HoReCa, Institutional, and general trade customer segments.
- Produced digital creatives: Social Media Posts, Carousels & Video Promotions, and website banners for high-impact campaigns.
- Reduced creative turnaround time from 5 days to 1–2 days via structured workflow implementation.
- Created nationally deployed signage & creative templates across the JioMart B2B network.

Assistant Manager – Sr. Visualizer

Nov 2011 – Apr 2020 (9 Years)

Reliance Market | Reliance Retail

- Directed a 15-member Studio Team in overseeing pan-India advertising campaigns, promotional literature, and artwork rollouts across 46 stores, managing the high-volume production of mailers, catalogues, press ads, and OOH creatives.
- Spearheaded strategic digital content creation that successfully grew the Reliance Market Facebook page to 7.5 Lakh subscribers (@RelianceMarket), and collaborated with external agencies to produce TVCs and video campaigns for the official YouTube channel (@reliancemarket2451).
- Accelerated brand visibility during the company's growth phases by supporting pan-India new store opening launches with targeted newspaper advertisements and impactful social media creatives.

Head Graphic Designer

Mar 2008 – Sep 2011 (3 Years 6 Months)

Akruti Cards, Vashi

- Managed end-to-end pre-press and print production for diverse clients across advertising, retail, and publishing.
- Designed Invitation card collections and allied stationery, building on print design foundations from prior printing press experience.
- Developed layouts, brand collaterals, and print-ready artworks including brochures, catalogues, and promotional materials.

Graphic Designer

Jan 2007 – Mar 2008 (1 Year)

Anupam Arts Printing Press, Vashi

- Handled graphic design, layout production, and pre-press workflows for print media including booklets, leaflets, bill books, letterheads, visiting cards, packaging, stationery, and advertising materials.

TOOL MASTERY & TECHNICAL SKILLS

PRIMARY TOOLS

- Adobe InDesign
- Adobe Illustrator
- Adobe Photoshop
- Microsoft Office 365 with Advanced Excel
- Generative AI User
- Vibe Coding

SUPPORTING TOOLS

- FIGMA
- After Effects
- Premiere Pro
- 3D-Blender
- Affinity • Canva • Adobe Express
- CorelDraw

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

EDUCATION

- MBA (Marketing) — 2018 J.R.N Rajasthan Vidyapeeth (59%)
- B.Com — 2015 J.R.N Rajasthan Vidyapeeth (64%)
- I.Sc. — 2000 | BIEC, Bihar (49%)
- Matric — 1998 | BSEB, Bihar (55%)

DIGITAL CERTIFICATIONS

- Google Ads for Beginners - **Coursera**
- Figma for UI/UX: Master Web Design - **Packt**
- Prompt Engineering for ChatGPT - **Vanderbilt University**
- RR AI Certification Program - **Reliance Retail**

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Rated Star Performer for three consecutive years at Reliance Retail
- Received the prestigious monthly R&R Award 3 times in the preceding year